AMPLIFY SCHOOLS

Brand guidelines

How we look, sound and show up, from letterheads to school stages.

Version 1.0 | November 2026

START HERE

The short version

If you only read one page, read this one. These six rules cover most of what you'll make for Amplify Schools.

1 Say our name in full

We're **Amplify Schools**. Two words, both with capitals. Not "Amplify" and not "AS".

2 Use the logo files as they are

Pick the colour, white or navy version from the logo folder. Never redraw, recolour, stretch or crop it.

3 Navy, teal and plenty of white

Navy does the heavy lifting. Teal is the accent for buttons, links and highlights. White space keeps it clean.

4 Three fonts, three jobs

Archivo for headlines. Public Sans for reading text. Arial in Word, Google Docs and email.

5 Warm, plain, a bit rock and roll

Write the way a friendly music teacher talks. Short sentences, real details, Australian spelling.

6 Real gear, real schools

Use real photos of instruments, workshops and handovers, and get permission before showing students or staff.

Putting rock instruments into school music rooms.

That's our tagline, and it's the test for everything we make. If a flyer, post or letter doesn't help get an instrument into a student's hands, simplify it until it does.

WHO WE ARE

Our name and story

Use these words when you introduce us. Copy them as they are so we describe ourselves the same way everywhere.

HOW TO DESCRIBE US

Tagline	Putting rock instruments into school music rooms.
One sentence	Amplify Schools is an Australian registered charity that refurbishes donated rock instruments and gives them to school music programs.
Short paragraph	Plenty of great instruments sit unused in garages and spare rooms while school music programs make do with tired, broken gear. Amplify Schools collects donated guitars, basses, drums, keyboards and amps, restores them properly, and gives them to schools so more students get to plug in, play and perform.
What we do, in three steps	Rescue and refurbish. Give to schools. Partner and play.

HOW TO WRITE OUR NAME

Everyday use	Amplify Schools
Legal and formal	Amplify Schools Incorporated Letterhead, receipts, agreements and grant applications. "Amplify Schools Inc." is fine where space is tight.
Website	amplifyschools.org Lower case, no "www".
Social media	@amplifyschools
Email	backstage@amplifyschools.org
ABN	32 761 982 262 Written with spaces, in groups of 2, 3, 3 and 3.

AVOID

"Amplify" on its own, "AS", "AmplifySchools" as one word (except in the web address and handle), and "AMPLIFY SCHOOLS" in capitals in running text.

LOGO

Our logo

An electric guitar outline beside a bold italic wordmark. It's the one thing that should look identical everywhere, so always use the supplied files.



Colour logo. Our first choice. Use it on white or very light backgrounds.



White logo. On navy, teal or dark photos.



Navy logo. For one-colour printing, stamps and engraving.



The "A" icon. Only for tiny spaces where the full logo can't be read, such as a browser tab or app icon.

WHICH FILE TO USE

PNG for Word, Google Docs, PowerPoint, Canva, email and social media.
SVG for the website and for printers and designers, because it stays sharp at any size.

LOGO

Space, size and placement

Give the logo room to breathe and keep it big enough to read.

CLEAR SPACE



Keep a margin on every side at least as tall as the letter **A** in "AMPLIFY". Nothing else goes inside the dashed line: no text, no other logos, no page edges.

SMALLEST SIZE



Print: 25 mm wide



Screen: 96 pixels wide

Any smaller and "SCHOOLS" becomes hard to read. Use the "A" icon instead.

PLACEMENT

- Top left is the default, as on the website and letterhead.
- Centre it only when it stands alone, such as on a cover, banner or profile picture.
- Use one logo per page or screen. Repeating it weakens it.
- Beside a partner's logo, keep both the same visual height with clear space between them.

BACKGROUNDS



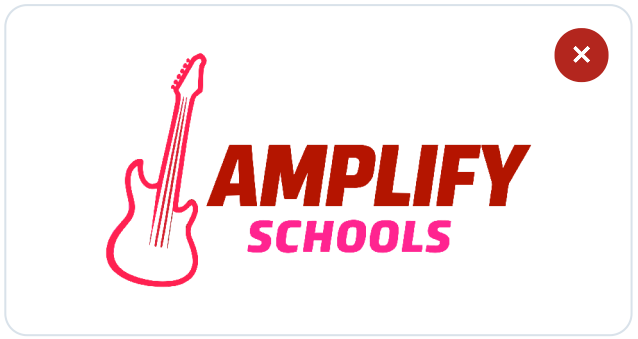
Colour logo on white or pale grey. White logo on navy or teal.

What not to do

The logo only works if it always looks the same. These are the mistakes that creep in most often.



Don't stretch or squash it. Hold Shift while resizing so it keeps its shape.



Don't change the colours. Use the colour, white or navy file.



Don't rotate or tilt it. The italic lettering already has movement.



Don't add effects. No shadows, glows, outlines or gradients.



Don't use the colour logo on colour. Switch to the white logo so it stays readable.



Don't crop it or pull it apart. The guitar and the words always stay together.

COLOUR

Our colours

Two brand colours, taken from the logo, on plenty of white. Use the exact values below so we match across screen and print.

Amplify Navy

HEX #1C3E66
RGB 28, 62, 102
CMYK 73, 39, 0, 60

Amplify Teal

HEX #0B7488
RGB 11, 116, 136
CMYK 92, 15, 0, 47

SUPPORTING COLOURS

Deep Navy	Ink	Slate	Mist	Teal Tint	Cloud
#14263E	#16283C	#435A70	#D9E2EA	#E2F1F4	#F5F8FA

Ink is for body text. Slate is for captions and small print. Mist is for lines and borders. Teal Tint and Cloud are for panels and page backgrounds.

CMYK values are a starting point for print. Ask your printer for a proof before a large run.

HOW MUCH OF EACH



Mostly white and pale backgrounds, navy for headings and solid bands, and a little teal for the things we want people to notice or click.

COLOUR PAIRS THAT ARE EASY TO READ

White on Navy	Any size
White on Teal	Any size
Navy on White	Any size
Teal on White	Any size
Navy on Teal Tint	Any size
Teal on Navy	Never: too hard to read

The first five pairs meet the WCAG AA standard for readable text. The logo artwork carries its own slightly brighter shades, so never recolour it to match these values.

TYPOGRAPHY

Our fonts

Two brand fonts, both free from Google Fonts, plus Arial for everyday documents where the brand fonts aren't installed.

HEADLINES

Plug in, play and perform.

Archivo ExtraBold Italic. Echoes the logo's lettering. Use it for headlines and big numbers only.

READING TEXT

We collect donated rock instruments, restore them properly, and give them to schools so more students get to play.

Public Sans Regular. Clear and friendly at any size. Use SemiBold or Bold for emphasis, buttons and links.

EVERYDAY DOCUMENTS

Thanks for registering your school. We'll be in touch as soon as we have gear that suits your program.

Arial. For Word, Google Docs and email, because it's on every computer. The letterhead template uses it.

USE	FONT	SIZE (PRINT)	COLOUR
Headline	Archivo ExtraBold Italic	24 pt and up	Navy or white
Subheading	Archivo Bold	12 to 16 pt	Navy
Body text	Public Sans Regular	10 to 11 pt	Ink
Small print	Public Sans Regular	8 to 9 pt	Slate
Buttons, links	Public Sans SemiBold	Same as body	Teal or white

TYPE RULES

- Write headlines in sentence case, not Title Case or ALL CAPS.
- Align text left. Centre only short headlines.
- On screens, keep body text at 16 pixels or larger.
- Don't use Archivo italic for paragraphs. It's for short lines only.
- Don't add other fonts, even for special occasions.

VOICE

How we sound

We sound like the people we are: music lovers who fix guitars and get them to schools. Friendly, clear and never corporate.

Warm

Talk to one person. Use "we" and "you". Say thanks often and mean it.

Plain

Short sentences and everyday words. Say exactly what happens to a donated guitar, and skip the jargon.

A bit rock and roll

A little band talk goes a long way: "Meet the band", "backstage", "keeping the amps humming". One riff per page is plenty.

Respectful

Schools, teachers and students are partners. We talk about what they can do with the gear, not what they lack.

SAY THIS	NOT THIS
We refurbish donated guitars and give them to schools.	We leverage pre-loved assets to drive educational outcomes.
Got a guitar gathering dust?	DONATE NOW to change a child's life forever!!!
Schools that need gear	Needy or underprivileged schools
Refurbished instruments	Second-hand or used instruments
Donations are not currently tax deductible.	Any wording that suggests a tax deduction, until we have DGR status

HOUSE STYLE

Spelling: Australian English (organise, colour, program). **Dates:** 11 November 2026. **Money:** $40, $150, $500. **Measurements:** metric. **Instruments:** guitars, basses, drums, keys and amps. **Exclamation marks:** one at most, and rarely.

PHOTOGRAPHY

Photos

Real photos of real gear and real people are the most convincing thing we have. A phone photo of an actual handover beats a polished picture of nothing in particular.



A real handover at Narara Valley High School: the instrument, the people and the place, all in one shot.

DO

- Show the instruments: on the workbench, in their cases, in students' hands.
- Capture the three moments of our story: gear arriving, gear being fixed, gear being handed over.
- Take before and after shots of refurbishments.
- Use natural light and get close. Faces and hands tell the story.
- Name the school and the people in the caption when you have their permission.
- Keep the original, full-size file.

DON'T

- Don't publish a photo of a student without written consent from the school and a parent or guardian.
- Don't publish photos of staff or volunteers without asking them first.
- Don't use stock photos to stand in for our own work.
- Don't present an AI-generated or illustrative image as a real school, student or event. Where a real photo exists, use it.
- Don't add heavy filters, borders or text over faces.

Keep a record. Note who gave permission, for which photos, and when. If someone asks us to take a photo down, do it straight away.

TRUST MARKS

Our charity details

Donors and schools look for proof that we're a genuine charity. Show these details clearly and word them the same way every time.

THE REGISTERED CHARITY TICK



The Tick belongs to the ACNC (Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission). We can use it while we stay registered, and only under the ACNC's rules:

- Never recolour, redraw, stretch or add effects to it.
- Keep it at least 15 mm wide in print, or 57 pixels on screen.
- Leave 5 mm (19 pixels) of clear space around it.
- Online, link it to our listing on the ACNC Charity Register.
- Use the colour Tick on light backgrounds and the white Tick on dark ones.

STANDARD WORDING

Footer line Letters, flyers, emails, receipts	Amplify Schools Incorporated | ABN 32 761 982 262 | Registered charity
Registration	Amplify Schools is registered as a charity with the Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission (ACNC).
Tax deductibility Anywhere we ask for money	Donations are not currently tax deductible.

Being a charity is not the same as being tax deductible

Only organisations the ATO has endorsed as a Deductible Gift Recipient (DGR) can offer tax-deductible receipts. Until we have that endorsement, never write "tax deductible" or "tax-deductible receipt" in an appeal, post or receipt. When our status changes, update this page first.

IN USE

The brand at work

Templates and examples that already follow these guidelines. Start from these rather than a blank page.

LETTERHEAD



Word template. Logo top left, legal details top right, contact line and Charity Tick in the footer.

EMAIL SIGNATURE

Your Name
Your role | Amplify Schools

0482 693 230
amplifyschools.org

AMPLIFY SCHOOLS

Amplify Schools Incorporated | ABN 32 761 982 262 | Registered charity

Arial, with name in navy bold. Keep it to these lines: no quotes, banners or extra colours.

SOCIAL MEDIA AND GOOGLE



Profile picture. The colour logo on white, with enough margin to survive a round crop.



Cover image. White logo and tagline on navy, centred.



Post. Real photo, a short headline, one clear thing to do.

TOOLKIT

Files and final checks

Everything you need is in the brand folder. Run through the checklist before anything goes out the door.

WHAT'S IN THE BRAND FOLDER

FILE	USE IT FOR
`logos/amplify-schools-logo-colour.png`	Documents, slides, email and social media
`logos/amplify-schools-logo-colour.svg`	Website, printers and designers
`logos/amplify-schools-logo-white.png`	Navy, teal and dark photo backgrounds
`logos/amplify-schools-logo-navy.png`	One-colour printing
`Amplify-Schools-Letterhead.docx`	Letters, in Word or Google Docs
`Amplify-Schools-Brand-Guidelines.pdf`	This document

Fonts. Archivo and Public Sans are free to download from fonts.google.com and free to use for any purpose. In Google Docs, find them under Fonts, then More fonts.

BEFORE YOU PUBLISH

- Is our name written as "Amplify Schools"?
- Is the logo an original file, unstretched, with clear space around it?
- Are the colours our navy and teal, with plenty of white?
- Does it read the way we'd say it out loud, in Australian English?
- Do we have permission for every person in every photo?
- Are the ABN and "Registered charity" shown where people expect them?
- Have we avoided promising a tax deduction?

Not sure about something? Ask before you publish: backstage@amplifyschools.org or 0482 693 230.